

S106 Night Quota renewal: our evidence pack

The Section 106 (Fourth Schedule) requires the night noise quota to be re-agreed every 5 years between the airport and BCP as local planning authority. If they disagree, an independent Specialist decides, weighing seven listed considerations. This outline maps our evidence to each one, so BCP can be armed before the airport's proposal lands.

Draft skeleton · owners are suggestions · verify all dates via the BCP records request

The mechanism and the moment

Every 5 years: the airport must propose the next quota to BCP **at least 6 months before expiry**, with reasoned justification. **BCP may refuse and propose alternatives** — including a lower quota. Unresolved disputes go to a **Specialist** bound by the seven considerations below. If nothing is agreed, **the old quota stays in force**, so pressing hard carries no risk. Our reading of the dates: current period likely runs to **~March 2028**, making the airport's proposal due by **~September 2027** (to be confirmed by the records request to BCP, along with what happened at the 2013, 2018 and 2023 renewals).

The seven considerations, and our evidence

(i) Night-time noise impact in the preceding years

IN HAND	Night arrivals (official 23:30–06:00 window) 251 → 490 (+95%) and large jets at night 159 → 411 (+158%) , 2023–2025; per-flight dataset independently benchmarked at 99.9% vs CAA figures; most large jets crossing the village below a standard 3° descent.
TO BUILD	Measured decibel evidence: the calibrated noise-monitor network (tied to flight tracks), plus WHO night-noise exceedance analysis once recording.
SUGGESTED	Michael (data) · Sue + brother (monitors) · Steve, John (host sites)

(ii) Night-time noise complaints

IN HAND	Growing complaints record, individually logged by the airport (its replies confirm logging). Nothing in the S106 discounts campaign-generated complaints.
TO BUILD	A central tally of the group's complaints (date, time, flight) so numbers can't be disputed; the airport's own complaint statistics from its annual monitoring reports (via Avery's records request); keep complaint volume up through the renewal window, especially for night flights.
SUGGESTED	All (keep complaining) · Guy (tally) · Avery (monitoring reports)

(iii) Past and future air traffic movements at night

IN HAND	Full 3-year per-flight record plus 2026 monitoring; CAA official movements +28% Jan–May 2026 vs 2025; permission to more than double passengers to 3m; possible cargo return.
TO BUILD	The airport's own night-movement forecasts (Master Plan and monitoring reports) to show projected growth against the unchanged quota.
SUGGESTED	Michael · Dave (Master Plan trawl)

(iv) Economic, social, environmental and commercial impacts

IN HAND	WHO night-noise guidance on sleep and health; National Park setting and tranquillity duty; resident testimony (waking events, clustering — a quarter of night arrivals under 8 minutes apart).
TO BUILD	A short public-health brief (WHO Lnight 40 dB vs what residents experience); community-impact statements from the PC, schools and tourism businesses.
SUGGESTED	Sue (health) · David + Claire (testimony collection)

(v) Policies and budgets at other relevant UK regional airports

IN HAND	Verified, sourced comparison: Southampton ~100 night movements/yr and no-night-flights policy since 1991; Bristol 4,000-movement cap; London airports movement caps <i>plus</i> QC budgets; Bournemouth: no movement cap, 3,100 points . The S106 itself makes this comparison a required consideration.
TO BUILD	Add 2–3 more regional comparators (e.g. Cardiff, Liverpool, Norwich) for completeness; the Southampton playbook note (how its conditions were won).
SUGGESTED	Michael (table done) · Avery (Southampton contacts)

(vi) National or regional policy guidance

IN HAND	Noise Policy Statement for England (LOAEL/SOAEL health thresholds); Aviation Policy Framework contours; CAA guidance recommending N60 night metrics to inform communities (Avery's CAA paper); WHO Environmental Noise Guidelines.
TO BUILD	A 2-page policy brief stitching these together: current night operations against each threshold, and why an unchanged 2007 quota is out of step with 2026 policy.
SUGGESTED	Avery + Guy

(vii) Economic and social benefits of the Airport

IN HAND	This is the airport's ground — but it cuts our way: by its own published chart it used only ~9% of the quota in 2022 (~267 of 3,100 points), so a substantially lower quota causes zero harm to current operations . We are not against the airport or its reasonable growth.
TO BUILD	Estimate current usage (2023–25) from our data + the monitoring reports, to show even today's doubled night traffic sits far below the budget.
SUGGESTED	Michael

The core argument: the airport uses a small fraction of a generous 2007 noise budget while night flights double underneath it and national policy tightens above it. A renewed quota set at, or below, actual current usage — paired with a Southampton-style movement cap and council monitoring — protects residents at **no cost to today's operations**. That is a proposal a reasonable LPA can adopt and a Specialist can defend on every one of the seven considerations.

Next steps

1. Avery's records request to BCP (dates, past renewals, monitoring reports) — on group approval. 2. Keep complaints flowing and start the central tally. 3. Stand up the noise monitors. 4. Draft the seven-section evidence pack from this outline as material lands. 5. Early engagement: ward councillors, PC, NFDC, National Park Authority. 6. Aim: evidence pack ready well before the airport's renewal proposal (~2027, date TBC).

Basis: Bournemouth Airport 2007 Section 106, Fourth Schedule (Night Time Noise Budget), reproduced in the airport's Noise Action Plan 2024 (quota usage chart, Figure 5). Flight figures: our own calculations from OPDI (EUROCONTROL) / OpenSky ADS-B data, benchmarked against UK CAA airport statistics (OGL). Comparators: Southampton, Bristol, Exeter airport publications and the DfT night-flight decision (Oct 2025). Internal working document — verify dates and figures before formal submission. Owners are suggestions for discussion.